

Healthy Screen Time Transition Contract & Boundary System

Dopamine Regulation & Family Digital Wellness Agreement | Framework: Behavioral Contracting & Pediatric Screen Time Guidelines

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Clinical Resource Packet

CHILD'S NAME	AGE / GRADE	DATE	COMPLETED BY

Family Digital Agreement & Transition Protocol

I, _____, agree to the following screen guidelines to keep my brain and body healthy:

DAILY SCREEN WINDOWS	PRE-SCREEN RESPONSIBILITIES (BEFORE SCREENS TURN ON)
- School Days: Max ____ minutes of leisure screen. - Weekend Days: Max ____ minutes of leisure screen. - All screens turn off at _____ PM (60 min before bed).	☐ Homework is completed and verified in folder. ☐ School backpack is packed at launchpad. ☐ 30 minutes of physical outdoor / movement play. ☐ Bedroom clothes put in hamper.

THE SMOOTH TRANSITION RULE	AGREED CONSEQUENCE IF RULES ARE KEPT OR BROKEN
The 5-Minute Warning: Parent sets visual timer at 5 minutes remaining. When timer rings, child hits "pause" and places device on charging station without screaming.	Bonus Earned: Transitioning smoothly on first chime earns 1 Token toward weekend privilege. If Screaming Occurs: Next day's screen time is paused by 15 minutes to allow dopamine regulation to reset.

Why Screen Transitions Hurt: Fast-paced digital games flood the brain with dopamine. Stopping suddenly creates a sudden drop in dopamine that physically feels like distress. Always offer a tactile or protein snack immediately upon screen shutdown.